

Phishing Awareness Checklist

Red Flags:

- ☐ **Shared Document, Digital Voicemail Link, or QR Code:** Be alert to emails, even those from contacts you trust, that ask you to open a link to a secure document or click a link to listen to a voicemail. Another common scenario is scanning a QR code with your phone. These are common scams to steal your account access.
- ☐ **Attachments:** Be wary of emails that request you to open an attachment (remember, only .txt files are fully safe).
- ☐ **Personal Information Requests:** Be alert to emails that request personal details – credentials, account information, and the like.
- ☐ **Urgency:** Approach emails skeptically if they insist on immediate task completion or predict disastrous consequences if you don't comply.
- ☐ **Sender's Email Address:** Be vigilant for suspicious domain names (e.g., www.dell3.com, www.MICROSOFT.com) and email address misspellings, extra letters, missing letters, and so forth.
- ☐ **Subject Line:** Look out for generic greetings from senders who should know your name. For instance, an email from your bank regarding your account should address you by your name, not as "Dear Customer."
- ☐ **Email Body:** Be cautious of poor spelling or grammar, particularly if personal information is being requested urgently.

Tips for Email Management:

- ☐ **Schedule** specific times of the day to review emails – ideally a time of day where you can be highly focused
- ☐ **Build good habits** – like any other habit, phishing awareness is built over time
- ☐ **Slow down** – give yourself time to review and assess your emails and ensure you're confident in their origin
- ☐ **Be skeptical and listen to your instincts** – often something about these emails just doesn't "feel" right – don't ignore that
- ☐ **Better safe than compromised** – even if you falsely report phishing, or delete a legitimate email, that is better than the alternative



What To Do:

- ☐ **Check the sender address** – the display name may be different from the actual sender address
- ☐ **Hover over the link** – check for domain names that seem weird or misspelled
- ☐ **Don't click on links if you don't need to** – go to the website directly when possible
- ☐ **Don't click the link to "download images"** for an email that doesn't come through correctly – if you know and trust the sender, add him/her to the Safe Sender list
- ☐ **Verify** (gut check) all encrypted email or shared documents – are you expecting it? Is it from someone you trust?
- ☐ **Call the person who sent it** – ensure its validity if you are suspicious
- ☐ **Send** the details of the email (time received, subject, who it appears to be from) to your IT support team for review to ensure authenticity. Do NOT forward the whole email. If it's phishy, they don't want it either 😊
- ☐ **Be extra cautious when using a mobile device** to check email